

Chingiringi × Amazon Associates

Integration phases — what the client signs up for, what the developer builds, and the order things have to happen in. Total dev time once approvals land: ~2 days.

Phase 1 — Sign up for Amazon Associates

Who: Client (business owner, not the developer)

Amazon ties the affiliate account to the business entity for tax purposes. The developer cannot sign up on their behalf.

Steps:

1. Go to `affiliate-program.amazon.in`
2. Sign up with business email + Chingiringi's PAN/GST + bank account
3. List **chingiringi.com** + Play Store / App Store URLs
4. Amazon reviews in 24–72 hours
5. On approval, copy the **Tracking ID** (e.g. `chingiringi-21`) and send it to the developer

Phase 2 — Generate PA-API credentials

Who: Client (≈ 5 minutes inside the Associates dashboard)

Inside Associates → **Tools** → **Product Advertising API** → **Join**. Amazon walks the client through creating (or linking) an AWS account. This AWS account is just a credentials wrapper — no servers, no hosting, free.

Output: an `AccessKey` + `SecretKey` pair. The secret is shown only once — copy immediately.

Heads-up — Amazon gives only **probationary** PA-API access until 3 qualifying sales happen within 180 days. Launch does not block on this. Manual product URLs work day one.

Phase 3 — Wire credentials into the backend

Who: Developer

Add to backend/ `.env`:

```
AMAZON_ASSOC_TAG=chingiringi-21
AMAZON_PAAPI_ACCESS_KEY=AKIA...
AMAZON_PAAPI_SECRET_KEY=...
AMAZON_PAAPI_HOST=webservices.amazon.in
AMAZON_PAAPI_REGION=eu-west-1
```

Phase 4 — Click + redirect with tracking tag

Who: Developer

Extend POST `/api/deals/:id/click` to: (a) generate a unique `clickId`, (b) persist a `Click` row, (c) return a tracking URL with the tag + subtag.

```
const clickId = nanoid(10);
await Click.create({ clickId, userId, dealId });
const trackingUrl = `${deal.affiliateUrl}` +
  `?tag=${process.env.AMAZON_ASSOC_TAG}` +
  `&ascsubtag=${clickId}`;
return { trackingUrl };
```

Frontend: `Linking.openURL(trackingUrl)` instead of the raw affiliate URL.

Phase 5 — Reconciliation

Who: Developer (manual until PA-API is unlocked)

Amazon does NOT push postbacks. Pull-based reconciliation, two paths:

Option	When	How
A. PA-API report sync (daily cron)	After 3 qualifying sales + PA-API approval	Fetch orders report, match ascsubtag → Click → User, insert Transaction, credit Wallet.pendingCashback
B. Manual CSV import (admin screen)	Day one, before PA-API approval	Client downloads weekly Earnings CSV from Associates dashboard, uploads via POST /api/admin/imports/amazon-csv, same matching logic

Launch with B, switch to A once unlocked.

Phase 6 — Payout to user

Who: Amazon → Chingiringi → User

Amazon pays Chingiringi monthly (≈ 60-day lock so returns can settle). When Chingiringi receives the bank deposit, the daily cron flips matching Transactions from **pending** → **confirmed**. User can then withdraw confirmedCashback via Razorpay X (separate Phase 2 build).

Developer effort summary

Step	Owner	Time
One-page sign-up doc for client	Dev	30 min
Amazon approval	Client (wait)	1–3 days
Env wiring + URL builder	Dev	1 hr
Update /click endpoint	Dev	1 hr
CSV import admin screen (Option B)	Dev	4 hr
Daily reconciliation cron (Option A)	Dev	4 hr
Wallet credit + Transaction lifecycle	Dev	4 hr
Total dev work (excl. waiting)		≈ 14.5 hr (~2 days)

Multi-merchant note — Amazon Associates only covers Amazon. For Flipkart / Myntra / Nykaa / etc., either repeat this flow per merchant or sign up with an affiliate network (Admitad, CueLinks) and integrate once. Most cashback apps run both: direct contracts with the top 3–5 merchants for better rates, plus a network for the long tail.